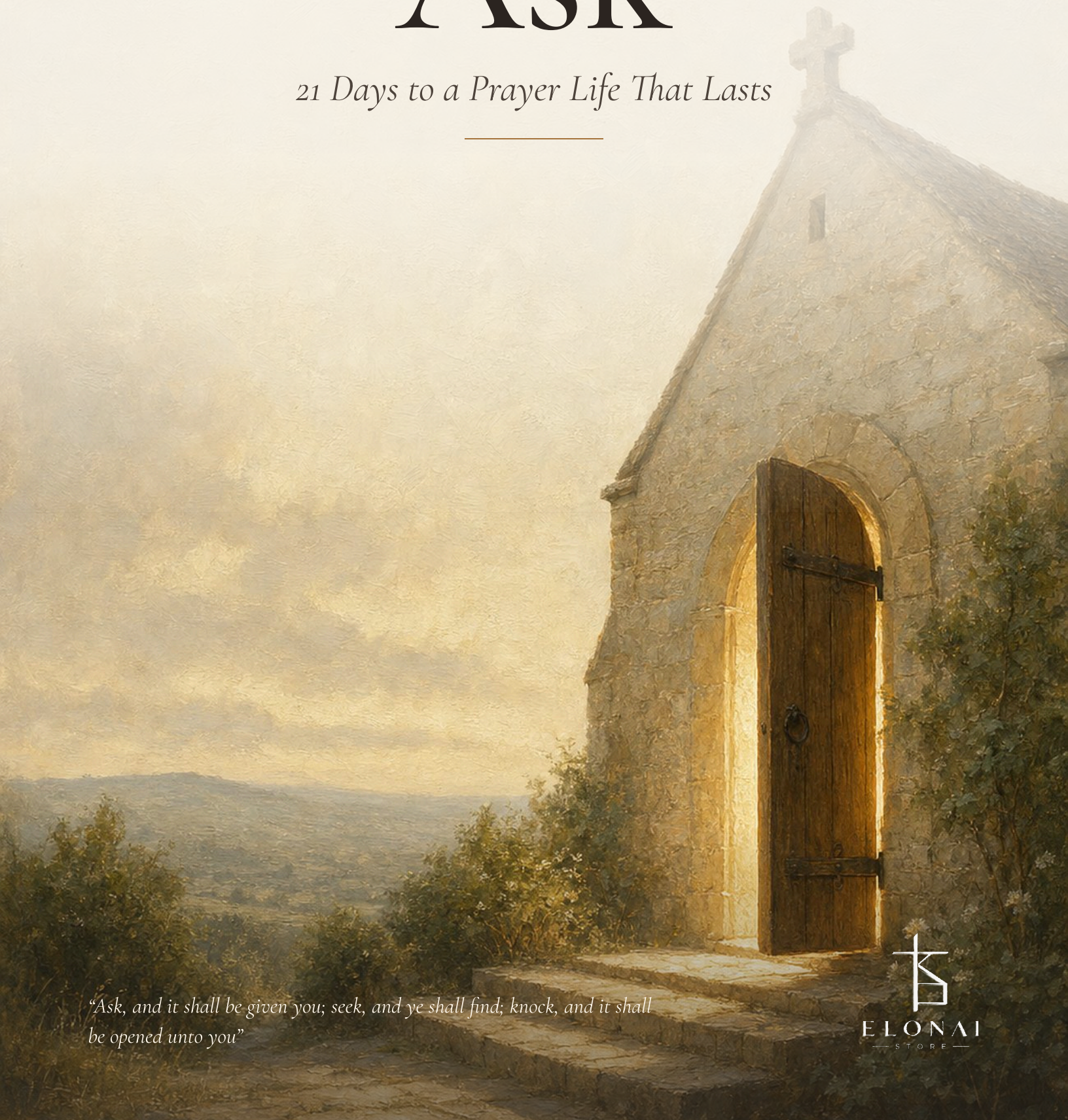
THE ELONAI DEVOTIONAL COLLECTION

A 21-DAY GUIDED PRAYER JOURNAL

Ask

21 Days to a Prayer Life That Lasts



"Ask, and it shall be given you; seek, and ye shall find; knock, and it shall be opened unto you"

ELONAI
STORE

Ask: 21 Days to a Prayer Life That Lasts

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A LETTER TO YOU

Dear friend,

Most of us want to pray more. Few of us were ever really shown how. We start strong, our minds wander, we run out of words, and before long prayer becomes a quick list on the way out the door, or something we feel guilty about not doing.

If that's you, you're in good company. The disciples lived with Jesus every day, watched Him heal the sick and calm storms, and the one thing they asked Him to teach them was this: *Lord, teach us to pray.*

This book is a free gift, and it's built for praying. Every day gives you a passage, a simple practice and a written prayer to start with, and then space for your own words.

Each day takes about ten minutes. In the first week, we'll walk line by line through the prayer Jesus taught. In the second, we'll learn from the prayers of men and women in the Bible. In the third, we'll practice persistence, listening and waiting, and remember how He has answered.

There's no perfect way to do this. God isn't grading your prayers. He's a Father who loves to hear His children's voices, even when the words come out messy.

So let's do what the disciples did and ask Him to teach us.

With love,
Elonai

BEFORE YOU BEGIN

The One at the Center

Every page of this book points to one Person. Before Day 1, let's make sure you know Him.

The Bible tells us that God made us to know Him and to rest in Him. But all of us have gone our own way. Scripture calls that sin, and it leaves us separated from God — restless, carrying burdens we were never meant to carry alone.

God didn't leave us there. He sent His Son.

> *For God so loved the world, that he gave his only begotten Son, that whosoever believeth in him should not perish, but have everlasting life.*
>
> JOHN 3:16 · KJV

Jesus lived the life we couldn't live, died on the cross for our sins, and rose again on the third day. He is alive today, and He still says the same words He spoke two thousand years ago:

> *Come unto me, all ye that labour and are heavy laden, and I will give you rest.*
>
> MATTHEW 11:28 · KJV

You can't earn this. You receive it. *"If thou shalt confess with thy mouth the Lord Jesus, and shalt believe in thine heart that God hath raised him from the dead, thou shalt be saved"* (Romans 10:9).

IF YOU WANT TO FOLLOW JESUS, YOU CAN PRAY SOMETHING LIKE THIS

Jesus, I'm tired of carrying everything on my own. I believe You are the Son of God, that You died for my sins and rose again. I turn from my own way and I trust You. Forgive me, fill me with Your Holy Spirit, and be my Lord. Amen.

If you prayed that for the first time, write today's date here: _____ . Then tell someone — a Christian friend, a local church, or our community (see the end of this book). We would love to celebrate with you.

HOW THIS WORKS

Ten minutes. Twenty-one days.

Each day has two pages. The first page is for **reading**; the second is for **responding**.

i.

Read

A short reading built around one passage of Scripture and one truth about God.

ii.

Hold one truth

A single sentence to carry with you all day. Short enough to remember at 3 a.m.

iii.

Practice & pray

One small, concrete step for today, and a written prayer you can pray as your own.

iv.

Write it down

An honest question and space to answer. Writing slows racing thoughts and helps you notice God's answers.

The journey

Week One — Teach Us to Pray. Walking line by line through the prayer Jesus gave His friends.
Week Two — Prayers That Moved Heaven. Learning from the honest, bold prayers of people in Scripture.
Week Three — Keep Asking. Persistence, listening, waiting and remembering how He answered.

A TIP THAT MAKES ALL THE DIFFERENCE

People who decide *exactly when and where* they'll do something are far more likely to follow through. On the next page, choose your time and place — and tie it to something you already do every day, like your morning coffee.

Reading on a phone or tablet? Write your answers in a notebook, or open this PDF in an app like GoodNotes and write right on the page.

MY COMMITMENT

I'm showing up for 21 days.

Every day, after I _____ ,

I will open *Ask* at _____ in _____ .

I'm starting on _____ . My one-word prayer: _____

✦

Color in a circle each day you finish. Watch the chain grow.

WEEK ONE · TEACH US TO PRAY

1 2 3 4 5 6 7

WEEK TWO · PRAYERS THAT MOVED HEAVEN

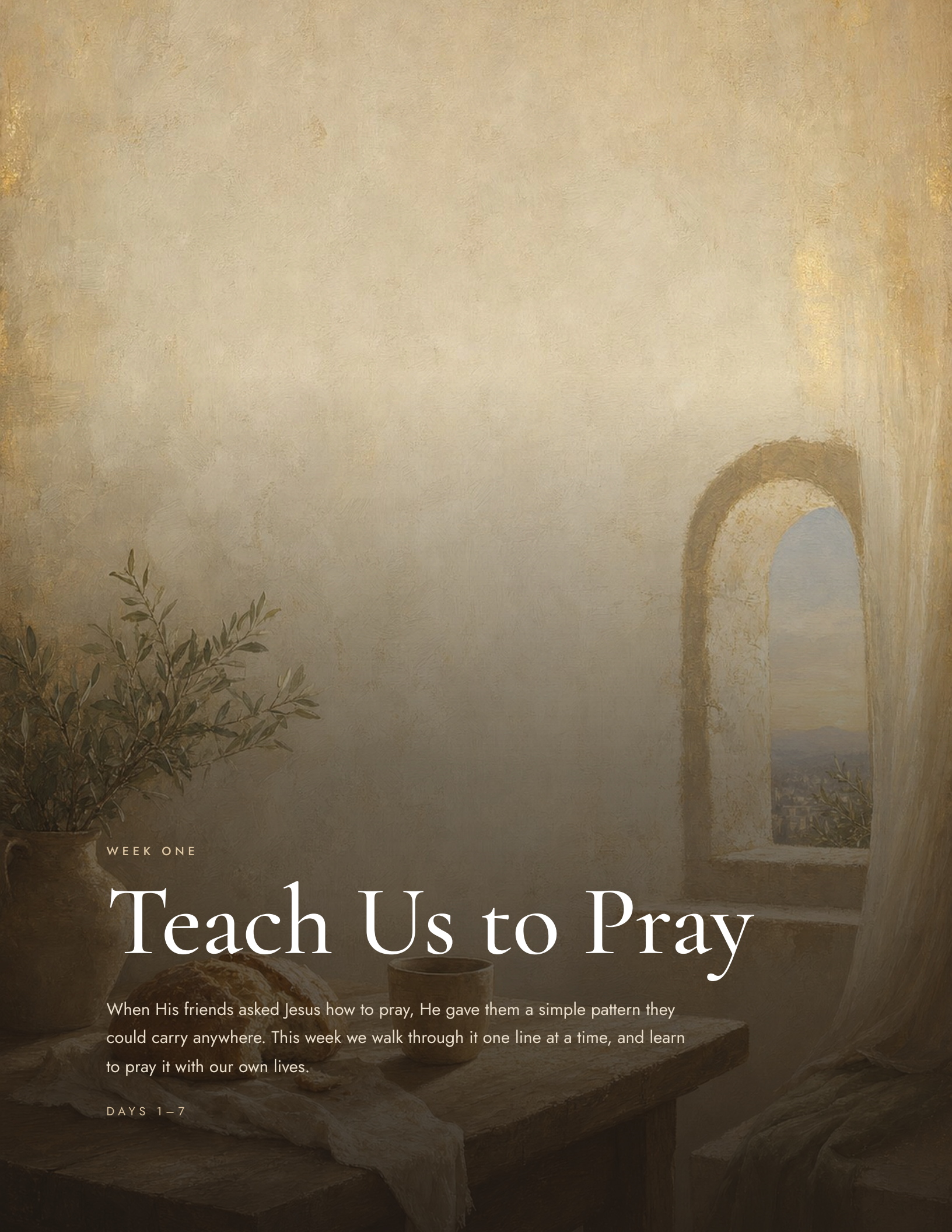
8 9 10 11 12 13 14

WEEK THREE · KEEP ASKING

15 16 17 18 19 20 21

MISSED A DAY?

Don't start over and don't feel guilty. Missing a day here and there doesn't undo your progress. Just turn to the next day and keep going. *His mercies are new every morning.*



WEEK ONE

Teach Us to Pray

When His friends asked Jesus how to pray, He gave them a simple pattern they could carry anywhere. This week we walk through it one line at a time, and learn to pray it with our own lives.

DAYS 1–7

WEEK ONE

Day 01 / 21

Lord, Teach Us

They had watched Him walk on water, feed thousands and raise the dead. But they never asked Him to teach them those things.

> *And it came to pass, that, as he was praying in a certain place, when he ceased, one of his disciples said unto him, Lord, teach us to pray, as John also taught his disciples.*
>
> LUKE 11:1 · KJV

The disciples spent years with Jesus and saw miracles up close, but what they noticed most was how He prayed. He rose early to pray (Mark 1:35). He withdrew to quiet places to pray (Luke 5:16). He prayed all night before big decisions (Luke 6:12). Prayer was the center of His life.

So one day, after watching Him pray, one disciple asked: "Lord, teach us to pray." It's a humble request. These were religious men who had prayed since childhood, yet they knew there was something deeper in the way Jesus talked with His Father, and they wanted it.

The first lesson of prayer is that we all start as learners. You don't need to know the right words or feel spiritual enough. You only need to come to Jesus and ask Him to teach you.

Over the next 21 days, that's exactly what we'll do. We'll walk through the prayer Jesus gave His disciples, learn from people who prayed in Scripture, and practice praying every day. Start today with the same simple words they used: *Lord, teach me to pray.*

TRUTH TO HOLD · DAY 1

I don’t need to be an expert. I can ask Jesus to teach me.

PRACTICE FOR TODAY

Choose your prayer time and place for the next 21 days. Today, pray just five words, slowly, five times: “Lord, teach me to pray.”

PRAY

Lord Jesus, I want to pray, but so often I don’t know how. My mind wanders and my words run out. Teach me, the way You taught Your disciples. Make prayer the center of my life. Amen.

JOURNAL

What has made prayer hard for me? What do I hope will change in these 21 days?

☐ Read today’s reading ☐ Prayed ☐ Did the practice ☐ Date: _____

Tomorrow Before Jesus gave His disciples any words to pray, He told them where to pray. Tomorrow we find a door and a secret place.

WEEK ONE Day 02 / 21

The Secret Place

With your phone buzzing, kids calling and thoughts racing, prayer needs a door you can close.

> *But thou, when thou prayest, enter into thy closet, and when thou hast shut thy door, pray to thy Father which is in secret; and thy Father which seeth in secret shall reward thee openly.*
>
> MATTHEW 6:6 · KJV

In Jesus' day, some religious leaders prayed loudly on street corners so people would admire them. Jesus said they already had their reward: applause (6:5). Then He described a different kind of prayer: a private conversation.

"Enter into thy closet." The word means an inner room or storeroom, a small private space in the house. Jesus wasn't saying prayer must happen in a literal closet. He was saying: find a place where it's just you and your Father, where no one is watching.

"And when thou hast shut thy door." This is the hard part: shutting out distractions: the phone, the to-do list, the noise. It's a choice to give God your undivided attention, even for a few minutes.

Then comes the promise: "thy Father which seeth in secret shall reward thee openly." Instead of applause, the reward is God Himself. Time in the secret place shapes your heart, and over time it shows up in how you live and love.

TRUTH TO HOLD · DAY 2

My Father meets me in the secret place.

PRACTICE FOR TODAY

Prepare your "secret place" today: a chair, a corner, a spot in your car. Put your phone in another room or on airplane mode during your prayer time.

PRAY

Father, I want to meet You in the secret place. Help me shut the door on distractions and give You my whole attention. I don't need anyone to see my prayers but You. Meet me here, every day. In Jesus' name, amen.

JOURNAL

What distractions most often interrupt my time with God? What "door" do I need to shut?

☐ Read today's reading ☐ Prayed ☐ Did the practice ☐ Date: _____

Tomorrow The prayer Jesus taught begins with two words that change how we approach God completely. Tomorrow we start with "Our Father."

WEEK ONE

Day 03 / 21

Our Father

How you address someone shows what you believe about them. Jesus began His prayer with a family word.

> *After this manner therefore pray ye: Our Father which art in heaven, Hallowed be thy name.*
>
> MATTHEW 6:9 · KJV

"After this manner therefore pray ye." Jesus had just warned against "vain repetitions" (6:7), so this is a pattern to shape our prayers, not a script to recite mindlessly. It begins with relationship.

"Our Father." Israel had long known God as the Father of His people (Isaiah 63:16). But Jesus invited His followers into His own closeness, to call God Father the same way He did. And He says "our" Father, not only "my" Father, because we pray as part of a family.

"Which art in heaven." He is near enough to be called Father, and great enough to rule over everything. We need both: without the first, prayer feels distant, and without the second, it feels small.

"Hallowed be thy name." To hallow means to treat as holy. Before asking for anything, we honor who God is. Prayer that begins with worship puts everything else in its proper size. Your problems aren't small, but your Father is bigger.

TRUTH TO HOLD · DAY 3

I pray to a Father who is near enough to hear and great enough to help.

PRACTICE FOR TODAY

Begin your prayer today by spending two full minutes only telling God who He is: "You are good, You are faithful…" Ask Him for nothing yet.

PRAY

Our Father in heaven, thank You that I can call You Father. You are near and You are great. Your name is holy. Before I bring You anything, I simply want to honor You. You are worthy of all my praise. In Jesus' name, amen.

JOURNAL

When I picture God as "Father," what comes to mind? How does Jesus' picture of the Father heal or change that?

☐ Read today's reading ☐ Prayed ☐ Did the practice ☐ Date: _____

Tomorrow The next line of the prayer is the boldest, and the most surrendered. Tomorrow we pray for His kingdom to come.

WEEK ONE Day 04 / 21

Thy Will Be Done

Most of our prayers start with what we want. This one starts with what He wants.

> *Thy kingdom come. Thy will be done in earth, as it is in heaven.*
>
> MATTHEW 6:10 · KJV

"Thy kingdom come." God's kingdom is wherever He reigns as King. In heaven His will is done perfectly, without sickness, injustice or tears. Jesus teaches us to pray that heaven's reality would come to earth, to our homes, cities and hearts.

"Thy will be done." This is a prayer of surrender. It means, "God, I want what You want more than what I want." This surrender is active: we trust that His plans are better than ours.

Jesus Himself prayed this way at His hardest moment. On the night before the cross, He asked if the cup could pass from Him, and then said, "nevertheless not as I will, but as thou wilt" (Matthew 26:39). He made an honest request and still held it in open hands. We can pray the same way.

When you pray "Thy kingdom come" over your workplace, your family or your struggles, you're inviting God to rule there. Then you become part of the answer, living as a citizen of His kingdom right where you are.

TRUTH TO HOLD · DAY 4

I want what God wants. I hold my requests in open hands.

PRACTICE FOR TODAY

Write down one situation you're worried about. Pray over it: "Your kingdom come, Your will be done here." Then ask, "How can I be part of Your answer?"

PRAY

Father, Your kingdom come in my heart, my home and my world. Your will be done, not mine. I bring You my desires honestly, and I hold them in open hands. Show me how to live as part of Your kingdom today. In Jesus' name, amen.

JOURNAL

Where do I most need God's kingdom to come right now? What am I holding too tightly?

☐ Read today's reading ☐ Prayed ☐ Did the practice ☐ Date: _____

Tomorrow After honoring God and surrendering to His will, Jesus teaches us to ask for something very ordinary. Tomorrow: daily bread.

WEEK ONE Day 05 / 21

Daily Bread

It might be the shortest line in the prayer, and one of the most freeing.

> *Give us this day our daily bread.*
>
> MATTHEW 6:11 · KJV

After praying for God's kingdom and will, Jesus teaches us to ask for something basic: bread. God cares about your groceries, your rent, your health and your job, and nothing in your life is too ordinary to pray about.

Notice two small words: "this day." Jesus didn't teach us to ask for a year's supply. We ask for today's needs, today. It echoes the manna in the wilderness, given fresh each morning. God wants us to depend on Him daily, not store up security apart from Him.

This is freeing, because most of our anxiety lives in the future. What if there isn't enough next month? Jesus brings us back to today. Later in this same chapter He says, "Take therefore no thought for the morrow … Sufficient unto the day is the evil thereof" (6:34).

"Give *us*." Again, it's plural. When we pray for daily bread, we pray for others too, and we become people who share our bread with those who don't have enough.

TRUTH TO HOLD · DAY 5

God cares about my ordinary needs. I can trust Him with today.

PRACTICE FOR TODAY

Make a simple list of today's needs (big and small) and pray through each one. Then look for one way to share "bread" with someone else this week.

PRAY

Father, give me this day my daily bread. You know what I need today: provision, strength, wisdom and peace. I trust You with today and leave tomorrow in Your hands. Make me generous with what You give me. In Jesus' name, amen.

JOURNAL

What are my "daily bread" needs right now? Where am I trying to carry tomorrow's worries today?

☐ Read today's reading ☐ Prayed ☐ Did the practice ☐ Date: _____

Tomorrow The next line is the only one Jesus explained further after the prayer. Tomorrow we find out why forgiveness matters so much.

WEEK ONE Day 06 / 21

Forgive Us, as We Forgive

Unconfessed sin and unforgiven hurt are like static on a phone line. Jesus teaches us to clear the line.

> *And forgive us our debts, as we forgive our debtors.*
>
> MATTHEW 6:12 · KJV

"Forgive us our debts." Sin is described as a debt, something we owe God that we cannot pay. Every day we fall short, in what we do, say, think and leave undone. Jesus teaches us to bring that honestly to God.

Confession is agreeing with God about what's true and then receiving His mercy, without groveling. "If we confess our sins, he is faithful and just to forgive us our sins" (1 John 1:9). Daily confession keeps our hearts soft and our relationship with Him close.

"As we forgive our debtors." Right after the prayer, Jesus explains this line further: forgiven people forgive (6:14–15). Holding a grudge while asking for mercy doesn't fit, and unforgiveness blocks the flow of grace in our lives.

Forgiving someone doesn't mean what they did was okay, or that you must trust them again right away. It means releasing them to God and choosing not to make them pay. It's often a process, but you can start today, in prayer.

TRUTH TO HOLD · DAY 6

I have been forgiven much, so I choose to forgive.

PRACTICE FOR TODAY

Take a few quiet minutes to ask God, "Is there anything I need to confess?" Then ask, "Is there anyone I need to forgive?" Write down what comes to mind and pray over it.

PRAY

Father, forgive me for the ways I've fallen short today. Thank You that in Jesus my debt is paid. Now help me forgive those who have hurt me. I release them to You. Heal my heart, and keep it soft toward You and others. In Jesus' name, amen.

JOURNAL

What do I need to confess? Who do I need to forgive? What would it look like to release them?

☐ Read today's reading ☐ Prayed ☐ Did the practice ☐ Date: _____

Tomorrow We end Week One with the last line of the prayer: a request for protection and a closing burst of praise.

WEEK ONE Day 07 / 21

Deliver Us

Jesus ends His prayer the same way He began it: looking up.

> *And lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil: For thine is the kingdom, and the power, and the glory, for ever. Amen.*
>
> MATTHEW 6:13 · KJV

"Lead us not into temptation, but deliver us from evil." God doesn't tempt anyone to sin (James 1:13). This line is a humble admission: we are weak, and we need His protection. It's asking God to guard us from situations that would pull us away from Him, and to rescue us from the evil one.

This is a wise prayer to pray every morning. We all have weak spots: anger, gossip, lust, pride, fear, comparison. Asking for deliverance before the day begins is like putting on armor before the battle, rather than looking for it in the middle.

Then the prayer ends with praise: "For thine is the kingdom, and the power, and the glory, for ever." It ends facing the same way it began: we started by hallowing His name, and we end by giving Him all the glory.

That's the full shape of the Lord's Prayer: worship, surrender, daily needs, forgiveness, protection and praise. You can pray it word for word, or use each line as a doorway for your own words. Either way, you're praying the way Jesus taught.

TRUTH TO HOLD · DAY 7

I am weak, but my God is powerful. I ask Him to protect me.

PRACTICE FOR TODAY

Name your top one or two temptations, and ask God specifically to guard you from them today. Then pray the whole Lord's Prayer slowly, pausing after each line.

PRAY

Father, You know where I'm weak. Lead me not into temptation, and deliver me from evil. Guard my heart, my mind and my words today. For Yours is the kingdom, and the power, and the glory, forever. Amen.

JOURNAL

Where do I most need God's protection right now? Which line of the Lord's Prayer has meant the most to me this week?

☐ Read today's reading ☐ Prayed ☐ Did the practice ☐ Date: _____

Tomorrow Week Two begins with a man who negotiated with God on behalf of a city that deserved judgment.

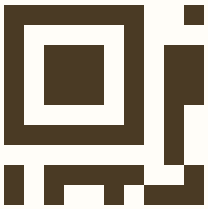
WELL DONE

You finished Week One.

Seven days of showing up. That matters more than you know. Before you move on, take a moment to look back.

THE TRUTH I NEEDED MOST THIS WEEK

WHERE I SAW GOD AT WORK



YOU DON'T HAVE TO DO THIS ALONE

Join our free community walking through *Ask* together. Share what God is doing, post a prayer request, and pray for one another. Scan the code, or on your phone tap here to join.

Coming up in Week Two: **Prayers That Moved Heaven**



WEEK TWO

Prayers That Moved Heaven

The Bible is full of ordinary people who prayed honest, bold prayers. This week we sit beside them: a friend of God, a leader, a king, a prophet and Jesus Himself, and learn to pray as they did.

DAYS 8 – 14

WEEK TWO

Day 08 / 21

Standing in the Gap

Abraham stood before the Lord and asked the same question six times. Each time, God said yes.

> *And he said, Oh let not the Lord be angry, and I will speak yet but this once: Peradventure ten shall be found there. And he said, I will not destroy it for ten's sake.*
>
> GENESIS 18:32 · KJV

God revealed to Abraham that judgment was coming to Sodom, a city full of wickedness, where Abraham's nephew Lot lived. Abraham didn't shrug. He drew near to God and began to plead: "Wilt thou also destroy the righteous with the wicked?" (18:23).

He asked if God would spare the city for fifty righteous people. God said yes. Then forty-five. Then forty, thirty, twenty, and finally ten. Each time, Abraham was humble ("I … am but dust and ashes," 18:27), and each time, God agreed.

Abraham's prayer teaches us that God welcomes bold, persistent prayer for others. Interceding means standing in the gap between God and someone who needs His mercy. Abraham knew God's character, "Shall not the Judge of all the earth do right?" (18:25), and he appealed to it.

Who in your life needs someone to stand in the gap? It might be a family member far from God, a friend in crisis or a nation in trouble, and you may be the only person praying for them by name.

TRUTH TO HOLD · DAY 8

God welcomes my bold prayers for others. I can stand in the gap.

PRACTICE FOR TODAY

Write down three people who need God's mercy. Pray for each by name today, boldly and specifically. Add them to the prayer list at the back of this book.

PRAY

Lord, thank You that You listen when we plead for others. I bring You the people on my heart who need Your mercy. Draw them to You. Make me faithful in praying for them, even when I don't see change yet. In Jesus' name, amen.

JOURNAL

Who has God placed on my heart to pray for? What do I want to ask Him for on their behalf?

☐ Read today's reading ☐ Prayed ☐ Did the practice ☐ Date: _____

Tomorrow Moses had seen plagues, a parted sea and fire on a mountain. Tomorrow we hear what he still wanted more.

WEEK TWO Day 09 / 21

Show Me Your Glory

Many of our prayers ask God to do something. Moses asked God to show Himself.

> *And he said, I beseech thee, shew me thy glory. And he said, I will make all my goodness pass before thee, and I will proclaim the name of the LORD before thee; and will be gracious to whom I will be gracious, and will shew mercy on whom I will shew mercy.*
>
> EXODUS 33:18–19 · KJV

Moses had led Israel out of Egypt and through the Red Sea. He had met God on Mount Sinai. But after Israel's sin with the golden calf, Moses pleaded with God not to send them on without Him: "If thy presence go not with me, carry us not up hence" (33:15).

God agreed. And then Moses made the boldest request in the Old Testament: "shew me thy glory." He didn't ask for more miracles or an easier journey. He wanted more of God Himself.

God answered by revealing His goodness and His name. In the next chapter, as He passed by, He proclaimed Himself "merciful and gracious, longsuffering, and abundant in goodness and truth" (34:6). God's glory is His character: His goodness, mercy and love.

Prayer is also how we come to know Him. Some of your best prayers might have no requests at all, only a longing: *Lord, I want to know You. Show me who You are.*

TRUTH TO HOLD · DAY 9

More than anything God can give me, I want God Himself.

PRACTICE FOR TODAY

Spend part of your prayer time today asking for nothing except to know God more. Read Exodus 34:6–7 and thank Him for each part of His character.

PRAY

Lord, I've brought You so many requests. Today I want something more: show me Your glory. Let me see Your goodness and know Your heart. Don't let me settle for Your gifts without Your presence. In Jesus' name, amen.

JOURNAL

If I could ask to see one part of God's character more clearly in my life right now, what would it be?

☐ Read today's reading ☐ Prayed ☐ Did the practice ☐ Date: _____

Tomorrow King David wrote one of the most honest prayers in the Bible after his worst failure. Tomorrow we learn to pray when we've blown it.

WEEK TWO Day 10 / 21

Create in Me a Clean Heart

What do you pray after you've done the thing you never thought you'd do?

> *Create in me a clean heart, O God; and renew a right spirit within me. Cast me not away from thy presence; and take not thy holy spirit from me. Restore unto me the joy of thy salvation; and uphold me with thy free spirit.*
>
> PSALM 51:10–12 · KJV

Psalm 51 was written after David's darkest chapter: his adultery with Bathsheba and the arranged death of her husband. When the prophet Nathan confronted him, David didn't make excuses. He wrote this prayer.

David doesn't minimize his sin: "Against thee, thee only, have I sinned" (51:4). But he also doesn't run from God. He runs toward Him, appealing to God's "lovingkindness" and "the multitude of thy tender mercies" (51:1).

"Create in me a clean heart." The word *create* is the same word used in Genesis 1, something only God can do. David knew he couldn't fix himself. He needed God to make something new in him: a clean heart, a right spirit and restored joy.

When you fail, shame will tell you to hide from God. This psalm shows another way: honest confession and bold trust in His mercy. God doesn't despise "a broken and a contrite heart" (51:17). You can come back, and He can make you clean.

TRUTH TO HOLD · DAY 10

When I fail, I run toward God, not away. He can make my heart clean.

PRACTICE FOR TODAY

Read Psalm 51 slowly today, as your own prayer. Underline the line you need most.

PRAY

Create in me a clean heart, O God, and renew a right spirit within me. I've failed, and I won't make excuses. But I trust Your tender mercies. Don't cast me away. Restore the joy of my salvation, and hold me up. In Jesus' name, amen.

JOURNAL

Is there something I've been hiding from God because of shame? What would it look like to bring it to Him like David did?

☐ Read today's reading ☐ Prayed ☐ Did the practice ☐ Date: _____

Tomorrow A young king was offered anything he wanted. Tomorrow we hear his answer, and why it pleased God so much.

WEEK TWO Day 11 / 21

Ask for Wisdom

If God said to you tonight, "Ask what I shall give thee," what would you ask for?

> *Give therefore thy servant an understanding heart to judge thy people, that I may discern between good and bad: for who is able to judge this thy so great a people? And the speech pleased the Lord, that Solomon had asked this thing.*
>
> 1 KINGS 3:9–10 · KJV

Solomon was young and newly crowned when God appeared to him in a dream and said, "Ask what I shall give thee" (3:5). He could have asked for wealth, long life or victory over his enemies. Instead, he admitted, "I am but a little child: I know not how to go out or come in" (3:7).

So he asked for "an understanding heart," literally, a listening heart, to lead God's people well and to discern between good and bad. And "the speech pleased the Lord." God gave him wisdom, and also gave him what he didn't ask for (3:13).

We face decisions every day: in parenting, work, money, relationships and faith. Many of them don't come with clear instructions. God invites us to ask for wisdom, just like Solomon did. James puts it plainly: "If any of you lack wisdom, let him ask of God, that giveth to all men liberally" (James 1:5).

Asking for wisdom is a prayer God loves to answer. It shows humility and a desire to do what's right. Whatever decision is in front of you today, start by asking for a listening heart.

TRUTH TO HOLD · DAY 11

When I don't know what to do, I can ask God for wisdom, and He gives generously.

PRACTICE FOR TODAY

Write down one decision you're facing. Ask God for wisdom about it every day this week, and write down anything you sense from Scripture, counsel or circumstances.

PRAY

Lord, I often feel like a child who doesn't know which way to go. Give me an understanding heart, a heart that listens to You. Help me discern between good and bad in the decisions in front of me. Thank You that You give wisdom generously. In Jesus' name, amen.

JOURNAL

What decision am I facing where I need God's wisdom? What would a "listening heart" look like in it?

☐ Read today's reading ☐ Prayed ☐ Did the practice ☐ Date: _____

Tomorrow Elijah was an ordinary man with an extraordinary prayer life. Tomorrow James tells us why that matters for us.

WEEK TWO Day 12 / 21

Ordinary People, Powerful Prayers

We tend to put Bible heroes on pedestals. James takes Elijah off his, on purpose.

> *Confess your faults one to another, and pray one for another, that ye may be healed. The effectual fervent prayer of a righteous man availeth much. Elias was a man subject to like passions as we are, and he prayed earnestly that it might not rain: and it rained not on the earth by the space of three years and six months.*
>
> JAMES 5:16–17 · KJV

James is writing about prayer for the sick, the struggling and the sinful. He tells believers to confess their faults to one another and pray for one another. Healing, in body and soul, often happens in community.

"The effectual fervent prayer of a righteous man availeth much." *Fervent* means earnest, wholehearted. *Availeth much* means it is powerful and gets things done. Prayer has real effects.

Then James points to Elijah, the prophet who called down fire from heaven. But notice how James describes him: "a man subject to like passions as we are." Elijah got tired, afraid and discouraged, just like us. Yet he prayed, and God answered in powerful ways.

You don't have to be a spiritual giant for your prayers to matter. You only have to be someone who belongs to God and prays earnestly. Your ordinary, fervent prayers for your family, your church and your friends can accomplish much.

TRUTH TO HOLD · DAY 12

My prayers matter. God uses ordinary people's fervent prayers.

PRACTICE FOR TODAY

Ask one trusted friend this week: "How can I pray for you?" Then pray for them right there, out loud if you can.

PRAY

Lord, thank You that I don't have to be a hero for my prayers to matter. Make me fervent and faithful in prayer. Give me friends I can be honest with, and let us pray for one another. Use my ordinary prayers to do much. In Jesus' name, amen.

JOURNAL

Do I believe my prayers actually make a difference? What would change if I prayed like they do?

☐ Read today's reading ☐ Prayed ☐ Did the practice ☐ Date: _____

Tomorrow He knew praying could cost him his life, and he prayed anyway, with his window open. Tomorrow we meet Daniel.

WEEK TWO Day 13 / 21

Three Times a Day

The law was signed: anyone who prayed to any god but the king would be thrown to the lions. Daniel went home and opened his window.

> *Now when Daniel knew that the writing was signed, he went into his house; and his windows being open in his chamber toward Jerusalem, he kneeled upon his knees three times a day, and prayed, and gave thanks before his God, as he did aforetime.*
>
> DANIEL 6:10 · KJV

Daniel was a top official in Babylon, respected for his excellent spirit. Jealous rivals couldn't find anything wrong with his work, so they targeted his faith. They convinced King Darius to sign a law forbidding prayer to anyone but the king for thirty days.

Daniel's response wasn't panic or protest. He went home and prayed, "as he did aforetime," as he always had. He had built that habit long before, three times a day, and the crisis simply revealed it.

Notice what he did in his prayer: he "prayed, and gave thanks." Under the threat of death, Daniel still found reasons to thank God. Gratitude was already part of his rhythm.

You won't build a strong prayer life in the middle of a storm. You build it on ordinary days, in small, faithful habits. Then when the lions come, you already know the way to your window. God shut the lions' mouths for Daniel (6:22), and He is faithful to you too.

TRUTH TO HOLD · DAY 13

Faithful habits on ordinary days prepare me for hard days.

PRACTICE FOR TODAY

Try Daniel's rhythm today: pray for two minutes in the morning, at midday and in the evening. Include at least one thanksgiving each time.

PRAY

Lord, I want a prayer life that's steady, not just one that shows up in emergencies. Build faithful habits in me like You did in Daniel. Help me give thanks even when life is hard. When the lions come, let me already know the way to You. In Jesus' name, amen.

JOURNAL

What habits do I want to build into my daily rhythm with God? What has helped me stay consistent in the past?

☐ Read today's reading ☐ Prayed ☐ Did the practice ☐ Date: _____

Tomorrow We close Week Two with a prayer Jesus prayed on His last night, and you're mentioned in it. Tomorrow you'll see where.

WEEK TWO Day 14 / 21

Jesus Prayed for You

On the night before He died, Jesus prayed for His disciples. Then He prayed for you.

> *Neither pray I for these alone, but for them also which shall believe on me through their word; That they all may be one; as thou, Father, art in me, and I in thee, that they also may be one in us: that the world may believe that thou hast sent me.*
>
> JOHN 17:20–21 · KJV

John 17 is the longest recorded prayer of Jesus. He prays for Himself, for His disciples, and then His prayer reaches across the centuries: "Neither pray I for these alone, but for them also which shall believe on me through their word." That's you.

What did Jesus pray for you? That you would be one with other believers, united as He and the Father are united. That you would be kept from evil (17:15). That you would be set apart by God's truth (17:17). And that you would one day be with Him and see His glory (17:24).

And Jesus is still praying. Hebrews says He "ever liveth to make intercession for them" (Hebrews 7:25). Right now, as you read this, the Son of God is praying for you before the Father.

So we never pray alone, and we never pray first: our prayers join a conversation already happening in heaven. When your prayers feel weak, remember that Jesus is praying for you, and His prayers are always heard.

TRUTH TO HOLD · DAY 14

Jesus prayed for me, and He is still praying for me now.

PRACTICE FOR TODAY

Read John 17 slowly today. Underline every request Jesus makes for His followers, and thank Him for each one.

PRAY

Jesus, it amazes me that You prayed for me before I was born, and that You're praying for me now. Thank You. Answer Your prayer in me: keep me from evil, make me holy through Your truth, and make me one with my brothers and sisters. Amen.

JOURNAL

How does it feel to know Jesus is praying for me? What does that change about how I pray?

☐ Read today's reading ☐ Prayed ☐ Did the practice ☐ Date: _____

Tomorrow Week Three begins with a promise in three verbs. Tomorrow we find out what it means to keep on asking, seeking and knocking.

WELL DONE

You finished Week Two.

Seven days of showing up. That matters more than you know. Before you move on, take a moment to look back.

THE TRUTH I NEEDED MOST THIS WEEK

WHERE I SAW GOD AT WORK

YOU DON'T HAVE TO DO THIS ALONE

Join our free community walking through *Ask* together. Share what God is doing, post a prayer request, and pray for one another. Scan the code, or on your phone tap here to join.

Coming up in Week Three: **Keep Asking**



WEEK THREE

Keep Asking

Prayer is a conversation that lasts a lifetime. This week is about persistence, listening, waiting well and remembering how faithfully God has answered.

DAYS 15–21

WEEK THREE Day 15 / 21

Ask, Seek, Knock

This is the verse on the cover of this book. Today we finally slow down and read it.

> *Ask, and it shall be given you; seek, and ye shall find; knock, and it shall be opened unto you: For every one that asketh receiveth; and he that seeketh findeth; and to him that knocketh it shall be opened.*
>
> MATTHEW 7:7–8 · KJV

In the Sermon on the Mount, Jesus gives three invitations: ask, seek, knock. Each one goes a little further. Asking is speaking up. Seeking is looking actively. Knocking is standing at a door and refusing to walk away.

In the original language, all three are in the present tense, describing ongoing action: keep on asking, keep on seeking, keep on knocking. Prayer is a relationship that keeps coming back to the door.

And the promise is wide: "every one that asketh receiveth." It isn't only for the holy or the deserving. Jesus then explains why we can trust this: even imperfect parents give good gifts to their children, "how much more shall your Father which is in heaven give good things to them that ask him?" (7:11).

That doesn't mean we always get exactly what we ask, when we ask. A good father sometimes says "wait" or "I have something better." But it does mean our asking is never wasted, and our Father never ignores us.

TRUTH TO HOLD · DAY 15

My Father loves it when I keep on asking. My asking is never wasted.

PRACTICE FOR TODAY

Choose one long-standing request that you've stopped praying about. Write it at the top of today's journal page and start asking again.

PRAY

Father, I've stopped asking about some things because I got tired of waiting. Give me faith to keep asking, keep seeking and keep knocking. I trust that You are good and that You hear me. In Jesus' name, amen.

JOURNAL

What have I stopped asking God for? What would it look like to start knocking again?

☐ Read today's reading ☐ Prayed ☐ Did the practice ☐ Date: _____

Tomorrow Jesus told a story about a stubborn widow and an unjust judge, for one specific reason. Tomorrow we find out what it was.

WEEK THREE Day 16 / 21

Don’t Lose Heart

Luke tells us the point of the story before the story even begins.

> *And he spake a parable unto them to this end, that men ought always to pray, and not to faint;*
>
> LUKE 18:1 · KJV

Jesus told a parable about a widow who kept coming to a judge who “feared not God, neither regarded man” (18:2). She had been wronged and she wanted justice. He kept refusing and she kept coming back, until he gave in just to stop her from wearing him out.

The unjust judge is a contrast with God, not a picture of Him. If even a heartless judge will answer persistent requests, “shall not God avenge his own elect, which cry day and night unto him?” (18:7). God is a loving Father, and He is not reluctant.

Luke tells us exactly why Jesus told this story: “that men ought always to pray, and not to faint.” *Faint* means to lose heart, to give up. Jesus knew there would be long seasons when prayers seem unanswered, and He wanted us to keep going.

The parable ends with a question: “when the Son of man cometh, shall he find faith on the earth?” (18:8). Persistent prayer is one of the clearest signs of faith. It says, “I still believe You hear me, and I won’t stop asking.”

TRUTH TO HOLD · DAY 16

I will keep praying and not lose heart. God is not reluctant to hear me.

PRACTICE FOR TODAY

Think of a prayer that has felt unanswered for a long time. Write a short note to God: "I haven't given up. I still believe You hear me."

PRAY

Father, some of my prayers feel like they're hitting the ceiling. Thank You that You are not like the unjust judge. You love me, and You hear me. Help me not to lose heart. Strengthen my faith while I wait. In Jesus' name, amen.

JOURNAL

Where am I tempted to give up in prayer? What would "not fainting" look like this week?

☐ Read today's reading ☐ Prayed ☐ Did the practice ☐ Date: _____

Tomorrow Is it possible to pray all the time? Tomorrow Paul gives us three short commands that fit in your pocket.

WEEK THREE Day 17 / 21

Without Ceasing

Three of the Bible's shortest commands are also some of its most life-changing.

> *Rejoice evermore. Pray without ceasing. In every thing give thanks: for this is the will of God in Christ Jesus concerning you.*
>
> 1 THESSALONIANS 5:16–18 · KJV

Paul closes his letter to the Thessalonians with a string of brief instructions. Three of them belong together: "Rejoice evermore. Pray without ceasing. In every thing give thanks." And he adds, "this is the will of God in Christ Jesus concerning you."

"Pray without ceasing" doesn't mean being on your knees 24 hours a day. The word means unceasing, constantly recurring: something that keeps coming back. It means staying in an ongoing conversation with God throughout your day, turning to Him again and again.

You can pray while driving, cooking, walking, waiting in line or lying awake at night. Short prayers count: "Help me." "Thank You." "Give me patience." "Be with her." Over time, these little prayers turn your whole day into time with God.

"In every thing give thanks." Not *for* everything, because some things are painful and wrong, but *in* everything. Even in hard seasons, there's always something to thank God for. Gratitude keeps our prayers from becoming only lists of complaints.

TRUTH TO HOLD · DAY 17

I can talk with God all day long, and give thanks in every situation.

PRACTICE FOR TODAY

Set three reminders on your phone today. Each time one goes off, pray one short sentence and give thanks for one thing.

PRAY

Lord, I don't want to only talk to You at set times. Teach me to pray without ceasing, to keep turning to You all day long. Give me a heart that rejoices and gives thanks, even in hard things. This is Your will for me, and I say yes. Amen.

JOURNAL

What moments in my ordinary day could become small prayers? What can I thank God for in the middle of something hard?

☐ Read today's reading ☐ Prayed ☐ Did the practice ☐ Date: _____

Tomorrow Sometimes we don't have neat words, only a heavy heart. Tomorrow we read a verse that says: pour it all out.

WEEK THREE

Day 18 / 21

Trust Him at All Times

Some days your prayers are neat and full of praise. Other days, they're tears and fragments. Both are welcome.

> *Trust in him at all times; ye people, pour out your heart before him: God is a refuge for us. Selah.*
>
> PSALM 62:8 · KJV

David wrote Psalm 62 while under pressure. People were trying to bring him down, flattering him with their mouths and cursing him in their hearts (62:4). In the middle of it, he says, "My soul, wait thou only upon God" (62:5). Then he turns to us with an invitation.

"Pour out your heart before him." Bring all of it, not just the parts that sound spiritual: the fear, the anger, the confusion and the grief. The Psalms are full of honest prayers that ask "why?" and "how long?"

Why can we do this? "God is a refuge for us." A refuge is a safe place to run in danger. God is strong enough to handle your honesty, and loving enough not to turn you away. He would rather have your real heart than your polite silence.

The word *Selah* appears often in the Psalms. It likely means a pause, a moment to stop and reflect. After you pour out your heart, pause and let the truth sink in: you are safe with Him.

TRUTH TO HOLD · DAY 18

I can pour out my whole heart to God. He is my safe place.

PRACTICE FOR TODAY

Write a completely honest prayer today, holding nothing back. Then sit quietly for two minutes (Selah) before you close your journal.

PRAY

Lord, You are my refuge. I don't have to hide anything from You. I pour out my heart before You today: the fears, the questions and the hurts. Hold them, and hold me. I trust You at all times. In Jesus' name, amen.

JOURNAL

What's really in my heart right now that I haven't said to God? Pour it out here.

☐ Read today's reading ☐ Prayed ☐ Did the practice ☐ Date: _____

Tomorrow Prayer is a conversation, which means it involves listening too. Tomorrow we look at how David started his days.

WEEK THREE Day 19 / 21

In the Morning

Before the emails and the news, before the to-do list starts talking, there's a quiet moment. David gave it to God.

> *My voice shalt thou hear in the morning, O LORD; in the morning will I direct my prayer unto thee, and will look up.*
>
> PSALM 5:3 · KJV

David made a habit of praying in the morning. "My voice shalt thou hear in the morning." He didn't wait until trouble came, or until the end of an exhausting day. He started his day by talking to God.

"In the morning will I direct my prayer unto thee." The word *direct* means to arrange or set in order, like laying out an offering on an altar, or setting out your case before a judge. David brought his requests to God thoughtfully, at the start of the day.

Then he adds, "and will look up." The idea is to watch expectantly, like a watchman on a city wall waiting for news. David prayed and then looked for God's answer throughout the day.

Many of us pray and then move on without watching for God's reply. Try David's way: lay out your requests in the morning, then spend the day looking up. Notice the conversations, verses, open doors and quiet nudges. God often answers in ways we only see when we're watching.

TRUTH TO HOLD · DAY 19

I will bring my day to God in the morning, and watch for His answers.

PRACTICE FOR TODAY

Tomorrow morning, before you check your phone, lay out three requests for the day. At night, write down any ways you saw God respond.

PRAY

Lord, You will hear my voice in the morning. Before the noise of the day begins, I lay my requests before You. Help me to look up, to watch for Your answers all day long. Open my eyes to see You at work. In Jesus' name, amen.

JOURNAL

What would change if I started my day with God before anything else? What will I "look up" for today?

☐ Read today's reading ☐ Prayed ☐ Did the practice ☐ Date: _____

Tomorrow Sometimes the answer is yes, sometimes it's no, and sometimes it's "not yet." Tomorrow we learn how to pray while we wait.

WEEK THREE

Day 20 / 21

When the Answer Is Wait

Habakkuk asked God, "How long?" God answered, but not with a date.

> *For the vision is yet for an appointed time, but at the end it shall speak, and not lie: though it tarry, wait for it; because it will surely come, it will not tarry.*
>
> HABAKKUK 2:3 · KJV

The prophet Habakkuk looked around at violence and injustice and cried out, "O LORD, how long shall I cry, and thou wilt not hear!" (1:2). His prayers felt unanswered. So he decided to stand on his watchtower and wait to see what God would say (2:1).

God's answer came: "the vision is yet for an appointed time." God had a plan and a timeline, even if Habakkuk couldn't see it. "Though it tarry, wait for it; because it will surely come."

Waiting is one of the hardest parts of prayer. Sarah waited decades for a child and Joseph years in prison. Even Paul asked God three times to remove his "thorn in the flesh," and God answered with grace instead (2 Corinthians 12:8–9). Sometimes the answer is "not yet," and sometimes it's "I'll give you something better."

By the end of his book, Habakkuk's circumstances hadn't changed, but his heart had: "Although the fig tree shall not blossom … Yet I will rejoice in the LORD" (3:17–18). Waiting well means trusting God's heart even when you can't trace His hand.

TRUTH TO HOLD · DAY 20

God's delays are not His denials. I can trust His timing.

PRACTICE FOR TODAY

Read Habakkuk 3:17–19. Write your own version: "Although ___ hasn't happened yet, I will rejoice in the Lord."

PRAY

Lord, waiting is hard. You know the prayers I've been praying for a long time. Help me believe that You have an appointed time. While I wait, change my heart. Even if my circumstances don't change yet, I will rejoice in You. In Jesus' name, amen.

JOURNAL

What am I waiting on God for? What would it look like to trust His timing in that area?

☐ Read today's reading ☐ Prayed ☐ Did the practice ☐ Date: _____

Tomorrow Tomorrow is our last day. We'll set up a stone of remembrance, and look back at how far God has brought you.

WEEK THREE Day 21 / 21

Hitherto

You've prayed for 21 days. Before you turn the page, let's stop and remember.

> *Then Samuel took a stone, and set it between Mizpeh and Shen, and called the name of it Eben-ezer, saying, Hitherto hath the LORD helped us.*
>
> 1 SAMUEL 7:12 · KJV

Israel had been defeated and frightened by the Philistines. Samuel called the people to turn back to God, and they gathered at Mizpeh to fast, confess and pray. When the enemy attacked, God thundered from heaven, and Israel was delivered.

Afterward, Samuel set up a stone and named it *Ebenezer*, which means "stone of help." He said, "Hitherto hath the LORD helped us." *Hitherto* means "up to this point." It looks back at everything God has done, and it looks forward too.

We forget so quickly. A prayer is answered, we're grateful for a day, and then the next worry crowds it out. That's why God's people built altars and memorials, and why writing down answered prayers matters. Remembering His faithfulness fuels faith for the next request.

Over these 21 days, you've learned to pray like Jesus taught, prayed alongside heroes of faith, and practiced asking, waiting and listening. Look back at your journal pages. Where has God helped you? Set up your own Ebenezer. Hitherto the Lord has helped you, and He isn't finished yet.

TRUTH TO HOLD · DAY 21

Hitherto the Lord has helped me. He will keep helping me.

PRACTICE FOR TODAY

Turn to the answered prayers page at the back of this book and fill in every answer you can remember, from these 21 days and from your whole life.

PRAY

Lord, hitherto You have helped me. Thank You for every prayer You've heard and every answer You've given, even the ones I didn't recognize at first. Help me keep praying, keep trusting and keep remembering. I'm not finished, and neither are You. In Jesus' name, amen.

JOURNAL

My Ebenezer: how has God helped me, in these 21 days and in my whole life? How do I want to keep praying from here?

☐ Read today's reading ☐ Prayed ☐ Did the practice ☐ Date: _____

You made it Turn the page — there's one more thing waiting for you.

TWENTY-ONE DAYS

Keep asking.

You've spent three weeks learning to talk with God, and you learned by praying. The habit you've started can carry you for the rest of your life. Keep coming back. He is always listening.

✦

Where do I go from here?

Keep the rhythm. Keep your same time and place. Begin each morning with the Lord's Prayer, then add your own words.

Pray the Psalms. Read one psalm a day for a month and turn it into your own prayer. The Psalms are the Bible's prayer book.

Pray with others. Join a prayer group or small group at a Bible-teaching local church, or ask one friend to be your prayer partner.

Pass it on. Think of one person who has said, "I don't know how to pray," and send them this book.

KEEP GOING

More free devotionals in the Elonai collection are waiting for you at **blog-elonai.vercel.app**

A GIFT THAT KEEPS GOING

Help the next person find Him.

This book was given to you freely, because no one should have to pay to hear that God is near. It will always stay free.

If these 21 days have blessed you, would you consider a small gift? Your support helps us keep creating free devotionals and prayer journals that help people talk with God.

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On your phone? Tap the button. **Printed copy?** Scan the code or type the address. It opens our secure giving page.

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Give safely: only use the giving links printed here or listed at blog-elonai.vercel.app/give. We will never message you asking for money or send a different payment link.

"Freely ye have received, freely give."

MATTHEW 10:8

Not able to give right now? Please don't feel any pressure. You can help just as much by sharing this book with a friend, or by leaving a note in our community about what God did in these 21 days. We read every one.

Gifts go to Elonai Store, an independent creator, to fund free faith resources. Elonai Store is not a registered charity, so gifts are not tax-deductible.

PASS IT ON

Who came to mind?

As you read these pages, someone probably came to mind: maybe a friend who's stopped praying, or a new believer carrying a burden alone. You can be the one who helps them start talking to God again.

GET A FREE COPY

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Text it, email it, share it in your small group or Bible study.
Every copy is free — always.

I'M SENDING THIS TO:

PRAYER LIST

Lifting them up

People and needs I'm praying for.

DATE	NAME / NEED	SCRIPTURE I'M PRAYING	✓

ANSWERED PRAYERS

He was faithful

Write it down so you never forget how He answered.

DATE ASKED	REQUEST	HOW GOD ANSWERED	DATE

CUT-OUT SCRIPTURE CARDS

Keep His Word close

Ask, and it shall be given you; seek, and ye shall find; knock, and it shall be opened unto you.

MATTHEW 7:7 · KJV

Pray to thy Father which is in secret.

MATTHEW 6:6 · KJV

My voice shalt thou hear in the morning, O LORD.

PSALM 5:3 · KJV

Create in me a clean heart, O God; and renew a right spirit within me.

PSALM 51:10 · KJV

Pray without ceasing.

1 THESSALONIANS 5:17 · KJV

Men ought always to pray, and not to faint.

LUKE 18:1 · KJV

The effectual fervent prayer of a righteous man availeth much.

JAMES 5:16 · KJV

Trust in him at all times; ye people, pour out your heart before him.

PSALM 62:8 · KJV

ELONAI

STORE

“Call unto me, and I will answer thee, and shew thee great and mighty things, which thou knowest not.”

JEREMIAH 33:3

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